



Sizana

Hyper-Local Community & Commerce Platform

A comprehensive technical and functional overview of the Sizana mobile application, detailing core features, user journeys, and scaling strategies.

PREPARED & ARCHITECTED BY

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1. Executive Summary

Sizana is a comprehensive, hyper-local community application initially targeting localized areas (such as Schweizer-Reneke, North West). It bridges the gap between social connection and local commerce by providing a unified digital ecosystem where residents can communicate, trade, organize events, and discover local businesses.

Built on a modern React Native frontend with a scalable Supabase backend, Sizana utilizes a zero-cost viral growth loop through deep-linking, allowing organic user acquisition via WhatsApp and social media.

2. Core Platform Features

Sizana is divided into distinct, seamlessly integrated modules designed to handle all aspects of community life.

Community Forums & Discussions

A dynamic space for users to post questions, share local news, and engage in threaded discussions. Features include full-screen image expansion, clickable embedded links, post ownership (edit/delete capabilities), and native thread sharing via deep links.

Local Marketplace (Buy & Sell)

A dedicated classifieds section allowing users to list items for sale. Users can manage their own listings, upload product images, and connect with potential buyers directly through the app's internal messaging system.

Events & Ticketing

A powerful timeline of community gatherings. Users can RSVP to public events, view attending counts, and purchase tickets via integrated external links. The platform supports **Private Events**—hidden from the public feed and accessible exclusively via secure deep-link invites shared over WhatsApp.

Business Directory & Direct Messaging

Utilizing an "Entity Ownership" model, users can register and manage businesses from their personal profiles. Businesses feature detailed profiles including operating hours, location, WhatsApp integration, and a native **1-on-1 Chat System** enabling direct consumer-to-business communication.

Activity Dashboard & Profile Hub

A personalized dashboard highlighting the most relevant upcoming events and active notifications. The Profile Hub acts as a command center, allowing users to track their forum posts, manage RSVPs, and quickly launch creation tools (Post, Sell, Event, Business).

3. Practical Use Cases

Sizana is designed to serve a diverse set of community members. Below are examples of how different personas interact with the platform.

USER PERSONA	SCENARIO & PLATFORM INTERACTION
The Local Entrepreneur	Registers "Touch Domain IT" in the Business Directory. Adds a logo, operating hours, and WhatsApp link. Receives direct messages from users needing tech support via the in-app chat. Also lists refurbished laptops in the Buy & Sell Marketplace.

USER PERSONA	SCENARIO & PLATFORM INTERACTION
The Event Organizer	Hosts a "Schweizer-Reneke Tech Meetup". Creates a public event on Sizana, includes a ticket purchase link, and monitors real-time RSVPs. Later, hosts a private family reunion, toggling the "Private" setting and sharing the generated deep link to the family WhatsApp group.
The Active Neighbor	Spots a stray dog in the neighborhood. Takes a photo and posts it to the Community Forums. Other users click the image to view it full-screen and reply with sightings. The user receives real-time push notifications via the Activity Center when comments are made.
The Deal Hunter	Checks the Buy & Sell tab for local agricultural equipment. Finds a listing, clicks the seller's profile, and sends a direct message through the app to negotiate a price and arrange a local pickup.

The Viral Loop Advantage: When the Event Organizer shares a private event link on WhatsApp, recipients who tap the link are prompted to download Sizana. Once installed, the app automatically routes them directly to the specific event, driving organic, zero-cost user acquisition.

4. Scaling Roadmap (Future Proofing)

As Sizana grows its user base and expands beyond its initial geographical boundaries, Seasons Digital has architected the following scaling requirements and future enhancements.

Phase 1: Infrastructure & Performance Scaling

- **Database Sharding & Read Replicas:** Transitioning Supabase from a single primary instance to utilizing read replicas to handle massive increases in directory searches and forum feed loads without latency.
- **Edge CDN for Media:** Implementing a global Content Delivery Network (CDN) to aggressively cache user avatars, marketplace images, and event banners closer to the user's geographical location.

- **Real-time Infrastructure Upgrades:** Upgrading the WebSocket architecture handling the 1-on-1 Chat System to support thousands of concurrent connections using optimized presence tracking.

Phase 2: Advanced Feature Integration

- **Native Payment Gateways:** Replacing external ticket links with native in-app purchasing (e.g., PayFast, Yoco, or Stripe) allowing users to buy event tickets and marketplace items securely within Sizana.
- **Algorithmic Feeds:** Upgrading the Dashboard and Forums from chronological sorting to engagement-based algorithmic sorting, surfacing the most relevant content based on user interactions.
- **Automated AI Moderation:** Implementing machine learning models to automatically flag and hide inappropriate marketplace listings, hate speech in forums, or spam in direct messages to protect the community at scale.

Phase 3: Monetization & Enterprise Tools

- **Sponsored Business Listings:** Allowing local businesses to pay a premium subscription to appear at the top of Directory search results or feature their services on the main dashboard.
- **Advanced Business Analytics:** Providing business owners with a dashboard showing profile views, chat engagement metrics, and click-through rates on their WhatsApp/Website links.
- **Multi-City Geofencing:** Updating the database schema to handle multiple cities automatically. Users will select their "Home Region" upon sign-up, ensuring they only see events, forums, and businesses strictly relevant to their immediate geographic area.

Document automatically generated from the Sizana architecture specifications.

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